



ORACLE
NetSuite

Cost Variance Analysis



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Cost Variance Analysis

The Cost Variance Analysis SuiteApp analyzes the variances that happen while you're running work orders. These variances are associated with quantity and cost between the planned values for the work order and the actual values recorded against the work order.

This SuiteApp also enables you to do the following:

- Measure how your work orders perform and help prevent cost overruns.
- Provide visibility to review work order cost variances at component and operation level. Review the work order including work order, cost type and cost category, with access to detailed information up to the transaction level.

You can access the SuiteApp from two places:

- Go to Reports > Cost Accounting > Cost Variance Analysis.
- Click on the **Cost Variance Analysis** button in a work order record.

You'll see the **Cost Variance Analysis** button in a work order record if:

- The work order status is not **Planned** or **Released**.
- The work order contains actual production start date.
- The work order is in view mode.
- The work order is not outsourced.



Note: Cost analysis isn't supported for work orders that use standard cost items.

Installing Cost Variance Analysis

The Cost Variance Analysis SuiteApp requires a NetSuite OneWorld account.

Only users with the Administrator role can install the SuiteApp. For more information about installing a SuiteApp, see the help topics [Installing from the SuiteApp Marketplace](#) and [SuiteApp Marketplace in NetSuite](#).

Prerequisites for Installing Cost Variance Analysis

To use the Cost Variance Analysis SuiteApp, enable the features in the following table. For more information, see the help topic [Enabling Features](#).

Subtab	Feature Name
Items & Inventory	Work Orders
SuiteCloud	Custom Records
	Server SuiteScript
	Client SuiteScript

Creating or Customizing Roles and Permissions to Use Cost Variance Analysis

If you are an administrator, you can create new roles or customize roles for using the Cost Variance Analysis SuiteApp. For more information, see the help topics [Assigning Roles to an Employee](#) and [Customizing or Creating NetSuite Roles](#).

A custom role **Cost_Variance_Custom_Role** is created during the SuiteApp installation. This custom role is used as a default value for **Execute As Role** field in the Script Deployment page. The role is also updated in the **Cost Variance Analysis SL** and **Cost Variance DataService** script.

Refer to the following table for minimum access levels of permissions required for SuiteApp deployments. These minimum permissions must be updated to the existing role or while creating a new role.

Permissions	Minimum Access Level
Transactions > Build Assemblies	View
Transactions > Build Work Orders	View
Transactions > Find Transaction	View
Transactions > Work Order	View
Transactions > Work Order Close	View
Transactions > Work Order Completion	View
Transactions > Work Order Issue	View
Lists > Address List in Search	Full
Lists > Bill of Materials	View
Lists > Currency	View
Lists > Custom Record Entries	Full
Lists > Documents and Files	Edit
Lists > Email Template	View
Lists > Items	View
Lists > Locations	View
Lists > Manufacturing Routing	View
Lists > Perform Search	View
Lists > Subsidiaries	View
Setup > Accounting Lists	View
Setup > Enable Features	Full
Setup > SuiteScript	View
Setup > SuiteScript Scheduling	Full
Setup > Set Up Company	View

Permissions	Minimum Access Level
Custom Record > Cost Variance MR Instances	Full

Refer to the following table for the minimum permissions required for logged-in user role.

Permissions	Minimum Access Level
Lists > Items	View
Lists > Subsidiaries	View
Lists > Locations	View
Lists > Documents and Files	View
Transactions > Find Transaction	View
Transactions > Work Order	View

Supported Browsers for Cost Variance Analysis

The Cost Variance Analysis SuiteApp supports the following browsers and operating systems:

Browser	Operating System
Google Chrome	Windows 10
	Mac OS 10.15 or newer
Microsoft Edge (Chromium-based)	Windows 10 or newer
Mozilla Firefox	Windows 10 or newer
	Mac OS 10.15 or newer
Safari	Two most recent stable major versions

Creating Cost Variance Analysis

The Cost Variance Analysis SuiteApp calculates the cost variances of work orders based on the selection criteria in the **Filters** section. You can view the cost variances of each work order in the **Work Order Summary** section. This calculation is based on the difference between the planned values for the work order and the actual values recorded against the work order.

To create a cost variance analysis:

1. Go to Reports > Cost Accounting > Cost Variance Analysis.
2. From the **Item** list, select the assembly item for which you want the cost variance analysis.
3. (Optional) From the **Location** list, select a location to view data for that location.
4. From the **From** list, select a date to define the beginning of the date range.
5. From the **To** list, select a date to define the end of the date range.

 **Note:** Following points are applicable to the **To** field:

- The from and to date range filters the work orders based on the actual production start date.
- The period between the from and to date should not be more than a year.

6. From the **Work Order** list, select a work order for which you want to see the detailed cost variance analysis.

 **Note:** Following points are applicable to the **Work Order** list:

- The field value in the **Work Order** list is displayed in WorkOrderNumber_ActualProductionStartDate format.
- The work order must have an actual production start date.

7. Click **Submit**.

You can view the **Work Orders Summary** section after the process is complete.

8. (Optional) To download the report, click **Download**.

 **Note:** Following points are applicable to the downloaded file in the SuiteApp:

- The downloaded file has the file name in the format ItemName_LocationName_FromDate_ToDate_timestamp.xls.
- Unsupported characters (\, /, :, *, ?, ", <, >, |, %) will be converted to underscore (_) in the file name.
- A scheduled script runs once a week to delete the generated cost variance report files from the file cabinet.

9. (Optional) To email the report:

1. Click the **Email** button.

A new browser tab opens.

2. In the **Email Recipients** field, enter the email addresses. By default, the field shows the email address of the user who's logged in.

 **Note:** Following points are applicable to the email option in the SuiteApp:

- The email addresses in the **Email Recipients** field must be separated by commas.
- You can add up to 10 email recipients in the **Email Recipients** field.
- You cannot email the Cost Variance Analysis report if the file size is more than 10 MB. So, you can download the report and email it instead.

3. Click **Submit**.

Note: Following points are applicable to the Cost Variance Analysis page in the SuiteApp.

- To generate a cost variance analysis report, you can either:
 - Enter a work order number in the **Work Order** field to see its detailed cost variance analysis.
 - Select an assembly item in the **Item** field to view the list of work orders.
- After you have selected the work order, the **Item** and **Location** fields will be grayed out. The item and location specified become defaulted in the work order.
- The work orders in the **Work Order Summary** section are sorted in descending order of the work order created date.

Work Order Summary Section

Select an assembly item, from and to date in the Cost Variance Analysis page, and you'll see the relevant work orders in the **Work Order Summary** section.

The following table provides details about the columns in the **Work Order Summary** section.

Column Name	Description
Work Order	Work order number. Click on the work order number to generate the cost variance analysis report.
Status	Work order status.
Location	Location of the assembly item in the work order.
Actual Start Date	Actual production start date of the work order.
Actual End Date	Actual production end date of the work order.
Build Quantity	Quantity to be built for the work order.
Built Quantity	Quantity built for the work order. If the built quantity is zero, the cost variance per unit will be empty.
Planned Cost	Planned cost for completing the work order. If the planned cost is zero and the actual cost is non-zero, the cost variance percentage will be 100%.
Actual Cost	Actual cost when completing the work order. If the planned cost is zero and the actual cost is non-zero, the cost variance percentage will be 100%.
Cost Variance	Cost difference between the actual cost and planned cost of the work order.
Cost Variance (%)	Percentage of cost variance per planned cost of the work order.
Cost Variance per Unit	The difference between actual cost and planned cost for each unit built.

Summary Section

The **Summary** section of the Cost Variance Analysis page includes the work order information, **Cost Category** subtab, **Component** subtab, and **Conversion Costs** subtab. You can sort the column values in any subtab.

You'll be directed to the **Summary** section if you've picked a work order in the **Filters** section. Else, click the work order number in the **Work Order Summary** section to get there.

Note: The following points are applicable to the **Cost Category**, **Component**, and **Conversion Costs** subtabs:

- Only the variance and variance percentage with value other than zero are highlighted.
- Positive variance is highlighted in red.
- Negative variance is highlighted in green.

The table below explains the work order information fields.

Field	Description
Subsidiary	Subsidiary name of the work order.
Bill of Materials	Bill of Materials of the work order.
Bill of Materials Revision	Revision version of the bill of materials.
Manufacturing Routing	Manufacturing routing associated with the work order.
Actual Start Date	Actual production start date of the work order.
Actual End Date	Actual production end date of the work order.
Planned Build Quantity	Quantity to be built for the work order. If the planned build quantity is zero, the planned cost per unit is empty.
Actual Built Quantity	Build quantity of the selected work order. If the actual built quantity is zero, the are empty.
Build Quantity Variance	Difference between the planned build quantity and the actual build quantity of the work order.
Work Order Status	Status of the work order.
Planned Cost	Planned cost for completing the work order. If the planned cost is zero and the actual cost is non-zero, the cost variance percentage is 100%.
Actual Cost	Actual cost for completing the work order. If the planned cost is zero and the actual cost is non-zero, the cost variance percentage is 100%.
Cost Variance	Cost difference between actual cost and planned cost of the work order.
Cost Variance (%)	Percentage of cost variance per planned cost of the work order.
Planned Cost per Unit	Planned cost per unit for completing the work order.
Actual Cost per Unit	Actual cost per unit for completing the work order

Field	Description
Cost Variance per Unit	Cost difference between actual cost per unit and planned cost per unit.

- Note:** The following points are applicable to number of records that you can see in the cost variance analysis summary report:
- The SuiteApp supports a maximum of 5000 work order completions in a single work order.
 - If you have multiple manufacturing operations, the SuiteApp supports up to 1500 work order completions with 100 manufacturing routing operations in a single work order.
 - You can only display up to 150,000 records with the combination of work order completions and manufacturing routings in the cost variance analysis summary report. For example, if you have 1500 completions and 100 routing operations in one work order, you'll see 150,000 records (1500*100).
 - The SuiteApp supports a maximum of 1000 different work orders in the work order summary report.

If the data exceeds the above-mentioned limits, the SuiteApp will show zero value in the **Conversion Costs** subtab for further routing operations. Also, the actual cost and actual cost per unit will be zero in the cost variance analysis **Summary** section.

Cost Category Subtab

The **Cost Category** subtab displays the variances for a work order by cost category. This subtab calculates the sum of all the costs under each cost category. This subtab is available for both work in progress and non-work in progress work orders.

- Note:** If no cost category is associated with any of the component items, there will be no data in this subtab.

The following table provides details about the columns in the **Cost Category** subtab.

Field	Description
Cost Category	Cost category type.
Planned Cost	Planned cost for completing the work order.
Actual Cost	Actual cost for completing the work order.
Cost Variance	Cost difference between actual cost and planned cost of the work order.
Cost Variance (%)	Percentage of cost variance per planned cost of the work order.

Component Subtab

The **Component** subtab displays variances for a work order by component. You can see the component item name even if the quantity issued or used is zero.

Check the **Only Display Variance** box to show only rows with a variance.

The table below explains the columns in the **Component** subtab.

Field	Description
Operation	Operation sequence in the manufacturing routing associated with the work order.
Item	Item name of the component.
Display Name	Another name for the item.
Planned Cost	Planned cost for completing the work order.
Actual Cost	Actual cost for completing the work order.
Cost Variance	Cost difference between actual cost and planned cost of the work order.
Cost Variance (%)	Percentage of cost variance per planned cost of the work order.
Planned Quantity	Quantity to be built for the work order.
Actual Quantity	Built quantity of the work order.
Quantity Variance	Quantity difference between planned cost and actual cost of the work order.
Quantity Variance (%)	The difference between planned quantity and actual quantity for the work order.

Conversion Costs Subtab

The **Conversion Costs** subtab shows costs for operations like labor cost, machine cost, and so on, for the selected work order. Total cost is the sum of labor cost and machine cost.

This subtab won't show any data if the work order isn't linked to a manufacturing routing.

The table below explains the columns in this subtab.

Field	Description
Operation	Operation sequence in the manufacturing routing associated with the work order.
Name	Operation name of the operation sequence.
Planned Total Cost	Sum of planned labor cost and planned machine cost. If the planned total cost is zero and the actual total cost is non-zero, the total cost variance percentage is 100%.
Actual Total Cost	Sum of actual labor cost and actual machine cost. If the planned total cost is zero and the actual total cost is non-zero, the total cost variance percentage is 100%.
Total Cost Variance	The difference between actual total cost and planned total cost.
Total Cost Variance (%)	Percentage of total cost variance per planned total cost.
Planned Labor Cost	Sum of all the planned labor costs associated with the operation. If the planned labor cost is zero and the actual labor cost is non-zero, the labor cost variance percentage is 100%.

Field	Description
	For more information, see Conversion Cost Formulas for Planned and Actual Costs .
Actual Labor Cost	Sum of all the actual labor costs associated with the operation. If the planned labor cost is zero and the actual labor cost is non-zero, the labor cost variance percentage is 100%. For more information, see Conversion Cost Formulas for Planned and Actual Costs .
Labor Cost Variance	The difference between planned labor cost and actual labor cost for the work order.
Labor Cost Variance (%)	Percentage of labor cost variance per planned labor cost of the work order.
Planned Machine Cost	Sum of all the planned machine costs associated with the operation. If the planned machine cost is zero and the actual machine cost is non-zero, the machine cost variance percentage is 100%. For more information, see Conversion Cost Formulas for Planned and Actual Costs .
Actual Machine Cost	Sum of all the actual machine costs associated with the operation. If the planned machine cost is zero and the actual machine cost is non-zero, the machine cost variance percentage is 100%. For more information, see Conversion Cost Formulas for Planned and Actual Costs .
Machine Cost Variance	The difference between planned machine cost and actual machine cost.
Machine Cost Variance (%)	Percentage of machine cost variance per planned machine cost.

Conversion Cost Formulas for Planned and Actual Costs

The following table contains conversion cost formula for planned and actual costs.

Cost Calculation	Planned Cost Formula	Actual Cost Formula
Labor Run and Labor Run Overhead	Cost * Labor Resources * (Run Rate/60) * Build Quantity	Cost * Labor Resources * (Labor Run Time/60)
Labor Setup and Labor Setup Overhead	Cost * Labor Resources * (Setup Time/60)	Cost * Labor Resources * (Labor Setup Time /60)
Machine Run and Machine Run Overhead	Cost * Machine Resources * (Run Rate/60) * Build Quantity	Cost * Machine Resources * (Machine Run Time /60)
Machine Setup and Machine setup Overhead	Cost * Machine Resources * (Setup Time/60)	Cost * Machine Resources * (Machine Setup Time /60)



Note: The following points are applicable for conversion costs calculation:

- The parameters related to planned cost formula are taken from the work orders and their respective manufacturing operation tasks.
- The parameters related to actual cost formula are taken from the work order completions.